

News Weekly

NASA launches its next-generation space telescope

NASA successfully launched the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope on Sunday, marking a significant advancement in cosmic exploration. The telescope, aboard a SpaceX Falcon Heavy rocket, lifted off at 7:26 a.m. ET from Kennedy Space Center, Florida. It swiftly reached space, ascending to 62 miles above sea level within minutes. The mission, costing \$4.3 billion and developed over nearly two decades, aims to survey hundreds of millions of stars and billions of galaxies. It will investigate dark energy and dark matter, potentially unlocking some of astronomy's biggest mysteries. The Roman Space Telescope is expected to revolutionize our understanding of the universe, providing panoramic views and insights into little-explored regions of the Milky Way while uncovering over 100,000 exoplanets.

Despite challenges like the COVID-19 pandemic and government shutdowns, the mission launched nine months ahead of schedule, a notable achievement for NASA. Astrophysicist Neil deGrasse Tyson emphasizes its potential to offer unprecedented data to solve enduring astrophysical puzzles. (NBC)



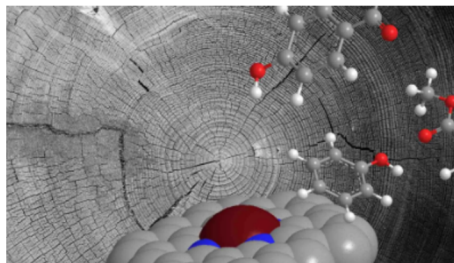
Mounting evidence suggests a link that the shingles vaccine cut heart disease risk

A study published in *Nature Medicine* reveals that the current shingles vaccine, Shingrix, is linked to a reduced risk of heart disease and heart failure. Conducted on over 70,000 individuals, the research found that those who received Shingrix spent 9% more time free from cardiovascular disease over seven years, compared to those who took the older Zostavax vaccine. Shingrix recipients were 10% and 12% less likely to develop heart disease and heart failure, respectively, and men had a 12% lower stroke risk. Despite these promising findings, researchers, including Emily Rayens and Maxime Taquet, emphasize the need for further investigation to establish a causal relationship between the vaccine and cardiovascular health benefits. (Nature)



Atomic catalyst unlocks the hidden value of plant waste

Lignin, a major component of agricultural and forestry waste, has been challenging to convert into useful chemicals due to its complex structure. A study in *ACS Catalysis*, involving Dr. Christopher Parlett and colleagues, introduces a breakthrough with a "single-atom catalyst" using ruthenium atoms embedded in nitrogen-doped carbon. This design enhances efficiency by activating oxygen to break lignin's robust bonds. The catalyst operates under mild conditions, efficiently converting lignin into valuable aromatic compounds like phenol, which are potential precursors for fuels and plastics. This innovative approach not only optimizes resource use by requiring minimal metal but also provides insights into catalyst function at an atomic level, paving the way for more sustainable chemical manufacturing methods. (Science Daily)



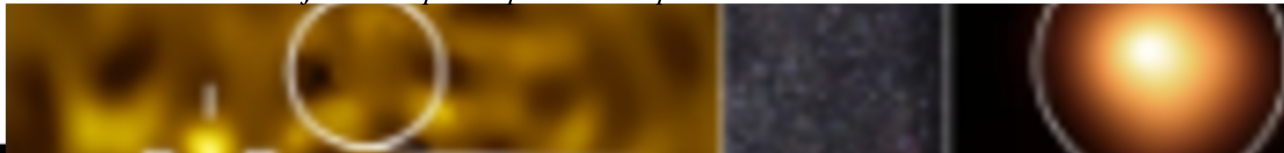
Shocking prehistoric discovery on NJ beach '100%' came from colossal ancient predator

While vacationing in Wildwood, New Jersey, the Bowers family's search for seashells took an extraordinary turn when they discovered a prehistoric treasure on the Jersey Shore. Mike Bowers and his 11-year-old son, Bo, found a massive tooth from an *Otodus megalodon*, an ancient shark that roamed the oceans millions of years ago. This unexpected find occurred near the Townsend Inlet in Sea Isle City on August 11. The tooth's impressive size, comparable to young Bo's hand, left the family in awe. Initially hesitant, Bo reached into a rock crevice at his father's urging and retrieved the fossil, marveling at its age and significance. The family, who had ventured out in search of shark teeth, was thrilled to keep this remarkable piece of history, discovered serendipitously on a public beach.



"Hidden companion" of Betelgeuse found after 100-year search

Using ESO's Very Large Telescope (VLT), astronomers have obtained the clearest image ever of what likely is Betelgeuse B, a star orbiting Betelgeuse, ending a century-long quest. The companion is more massive than initially predicted, boasting two to three times the Sun's mass. This breakthrough, facilitated by advanced imaging techniques, marks a significant achievement in astronomy. Betelgeuse's companion could influence the star's evolution and its eventual supernova. Further observations are needed to confirm the companion's presence and impact. (Science Daily)



Jokes

What do cats eat for breakfast ?

Mice Krispies.

Halloween



Fill in the blank squares so that every row across, every column down and each box contains the numbers 1 to 9 and letters A to G only

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B	5			3	9	D		F	1		2	4		8
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		3	F		E		7	D		4	G	A	1	B

Milanesa Napolitana

- 4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts
 - Salt and pepper, to taste
 - 1 cup all-purpose flour
 - 2 eggs, beaten
 - A little parsley
 - 2 cups Italian-style breadcrumbs
 - ½ cup grated Parmesan cheese
 - Olive oil for frying
 - 2 tablespoons olive oil (for sauce)
 - 2 cloves garlic, minced
 - 1 can (14 oz) crushed tomatoes
 - 1 teaspoon dried oregano
 - 1 teaspoon dried basil (or a few fresh basil leaves)
 - 1 teaspoon sugar (optional, to balance acidity)
 - Additional salt and pepper to taste
 - 1–2 cups shredded mozzarella cheese
 - Fresh basil for garnish
1. Prepare the chicken: Butterfly the chicken breasts and pound them to an even thickness. Season with salt and pepper.
 2. Coat each breast in flour, dip in beaten eggs, then coat with a mixture of breadcrumbs and grated Parmesan.
 3. Heat olive oil in a skillet over medium heat. Fry each cutlet 4–5 minutes per side until golden and crispy. Transfer to a baking dish.
 4. In a separate pan, heat olive oil over medium heat. Sauté minced garlic for 1 minute, add crushed tomatoes, oregano, basil, sugar, salt, and pepper. Simmer for 20 minutes for a rich sauce.
 5. Spoon generous amounts of tomato sauce over each breaded chicken cutlet. Layer mozzarella cheese (and optional ham slices if desired).
 6. : Preheat oven to 400°F (200°C). Bake the assembled cutlets 10–15 minutes until the cheese melts, becomes bubbly, and lightly golden. Garnish with fresh basil.
 7. Serve immediately For extra crispiness, you can briefly broil the cheese before serving.